

More muscle

N. Ridgeville erupts again for big quarter

Ron Nenadal
The Chronicle-Telegram

NORTH RIDGEVILLE — North Ridgeville did it again.

Three days after scoring 32 points in a quarter against Streetsboro, the Rangers were back at it Friday.

This time it was a 31-point third quarter that produced an 82-66 Pioneer Conference victory over North Royalton.

Okay, it was one-point short of the Streetsboro demolition, but who's quibbling?

Certainly not North Ridgeville coach Dan Rademaker.

"We went into the locker room and talked about defensive rebounding, which we didn't do a very good job of in the first half," Rademaker said. "(We also talked) about continuing our shooting because we were taking good shots — they just weren't falling — and about getting into the faces of their 3-point shooters a little better. For some reason we don't come out with a lot of intensity until the second half. Fortunatley it worked out for us tonight."

The third quarter explosion turned a 35-28 halftime deficit into a 59-52 lead after three. The Rangers outscored North Royalton 13-2 in the first three minutes of the second half.

Brad Thompson was the big gun for the Rangers during the run, scoring 10 of his 16 points to start the third quarter. Dustin Reynolds scored eight points and Matt Davin came off the bench to add another six during the run.

The Bears never regained the lead. North Ridgeville closed out the game by outscoring North Royalton 23-14 in the fourth quarter.

"Our lack of defense was our main problem tonight," North Royalton head coach Jeff Shepherd said after the game. "Offensively, 66 points is enough to win a game, but you have to stop the other team. Thirty-four (Brad Thompson) came out and hit some nice shots so we said we'll have to guard him. He wasn't looking to shoot in the first half. His threes didn't win the game for them. They were more aggressive than we were. They went to the line 29 times and made 23. We were 5 for 9. We just didn't play defense. They ran several back-door plays that we didn't defense."

North Ridgeville improved its conference record to 4-6, 6-9 overall.

The Bears' Bob Paradise led all scorers with 25 points while Reynolds took runner-up with 20 for the Rangers.

North Royalton travels to Rocky River Saturday while North Ridgeville travels to Berea next Friday to continue conference play.

N.Ridge					N.Roy.				
G	F	T			G	F	T		
Caspy	7	1	1	1	Florio	1	0	2	
Reynolds	2	1	1	1	Hanshan	1	0	2	
McCoolin	2	2	3	3	Dohar	4	1	5	
Mook	5	2	12	12	Beckler	3	0	8	
Davin	3	0	6	6	Paradise	9	2	25	
EdThompson	8	2	14	14	Davarak	7	0	17	
Reynolds	1	3	5	5	Schmidl	1	0	2	
Linte	4	5	14						
Totals	27	28	82	Totals	27	5	66		

Three-point goals: N.Ridge — Bra Thompson (2), Linte; N.Roy. — Paradise (5), Dohar, Der-shak.
Junior varsity: North Royalton, 71-59.

GIRLS BASKETBALL

Lantz's record highlights win

ELYRIA — Lyndsey Lantz set a school career scoring record as Elyria First Baptist swamped North Coast Christian 48-22 Friday night.

Lantz scored 20 points and now has 805 for her career — two points better than the previous record — with five games left.

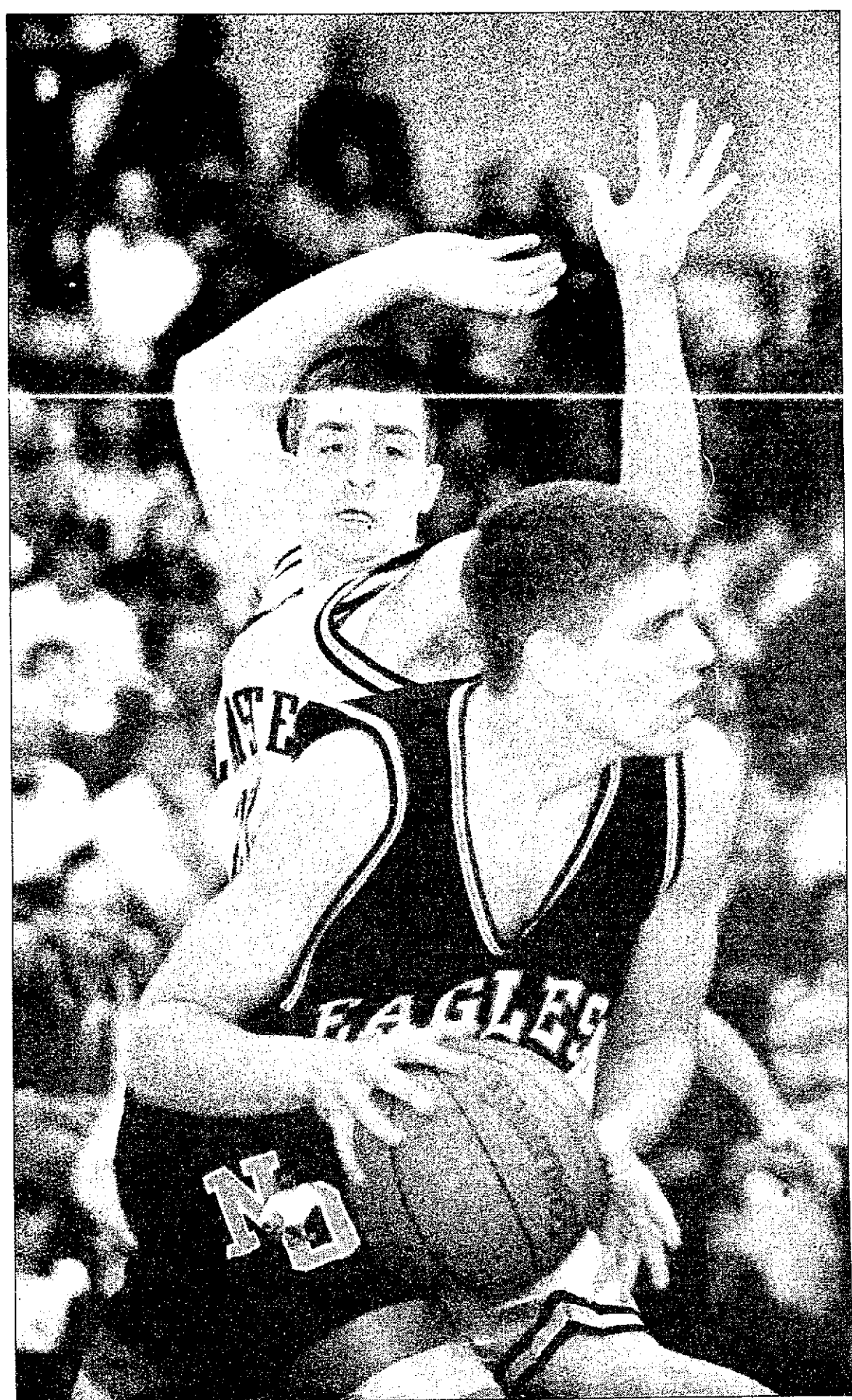
Curiously, both teams had scoreless quarters. North Coast failed to score in the second quarter and First Baptist in the last, but by that time the winners had a 48-13 lead.

Erin Lantz added 16 for the winners and Candace Shannon had 10 for North Coast.

First Baptist, 9-5, is at Willo-Hill this afternoon at 2.

1st Baptist					N. Coast				
G	F	T			G	F	T		
Savina	1	0	2	Kump	2	1	5		
Kinder	1	0	2	Shannon	4	0	10		
ELantz	8	0	16	Jankowski	1	0	2		
Kus	1	0	2	Schmidl	1	0	2		
Lantz	4	0	20	Christffersn	0	0	0		
McDonald	1	0	2						
McDonald	1	0	2						
Dakmon	1	0	2						
Totals	22	4	48	Totals	8	4	22		

Three-point goals: North Coast: Shannon 2.



STOP SIGN: Olmsted Falls' Rob Szczech tries to stop North Olmsted's Ryan Wingenfeld during Southwestern Conference action Friday night.

Who were those guys?

Rejuvenated Olmsted Falls stuns N. Olmsted

Steve Byrne
The Chronicle-Telegram

OLMSTED FALLS — The real Olmsted Falls team must have locked those imposters who played the first half in the locker room at halftime.

Like the cavalry coming to rescue the besieged fort, Falls executed an about face in the latter quarters and defeated North Olmsted 59-48 in a Southwestern Conference game. The Bulldogs outscored North Olmsted 41-10 in the second half after trailing 38-18 at the break.

"This is a young team," Falls coach Pat Donahue said. "I think they were a little scared in the first half. The loss to Rocky River might have made them nervous."

The Bulldogs saw a 39-game SWC winning streak broken last week after falling to Rocky River. The two remain tied for first place in the conference at 10-1, as River defeated Westlake 54-34 on Friday. Falls is 12-2 overall.

Bad shooting hounded the Bulldogs through the first half. Falls made five of 26 field goal tries and six of 15 at the foul line. They were outrebounded 19-13.

"We played as poor a first half as we could," Donahue said. "The pressure was non-existent. We took bad angles. We knew we had to pick things up in the second half."

The heavy lifting was done by Sean Radigan, who was held to one point (1-for-6 at the foul

N.Olmsted					O.Falls				
G	F	T			G	F	T		
Janis	1	0	2	Mucha	1	1	3		
Steele	5	2	14	Knapp	1	2	1		
Ryan	3	0	8	M.Wins	1	4	6		
Husak	4	0	10	B.Wins	1	2	4		
Wingfield	4	1	9	Radigan	1	8	23		
Kerr	1	0	2	Szczech	2	2	6		
Hazzard	0	0	0	Gansey	4	1	9		
Mezicka	1	1	3	Koch	0	0	0		
				Holland	0	0	1		
				Miller	1	0	1		
Totals	20	4	48	Totals	19	15	58		

line) in the opening half. Radigan scored 11 points in both the third and fourth quarters (6-for-9 at the line).

"Sean's one of our leaders," Donahue said. "He and Manzie (Williams) have the experience. When Sean showed us 'Hey, this game's not over yet,' everyone else decided to pull together and try to win it."

The loss dropped North Olmsted to 10-6 overall and 7-4 in the conference.

"We had a rebounding advantage in the first half and got outrebounded in the second half," Coach Tim Schmotzer said. "We committed eight turnovers in the first half and 18 in the second half. That was still no excuse to be outscored by 31 points in one half."

The Eagles ended with 31 rebounds to 33 for Falls. Brian Williams of the Dogs led all rebounders with 11. Ryan Wingenfeld had 10 for the Eagles, nine in the first half. Olmsted Falls committed nine turnovers for the evening.

"What we have to turn

around is attitude," Schmotzer added. "Olmsted Falls will do everything it can do to win, while we're more afraid of losing. If we can turn around our attitude we'll be fine."

"We needed to keep attacking, play with poise and keep rebounding. We didn't do any of those things in the second half."

Mike Husak scored 10 points and James Steele had nine as North built a 21-11 lead after one quarter.

The Eagles had a 10-point run to open a 31-13 lead with five minutes to go in the second quarter. Their lead was as wide as 22 points with 44 seconds before halftime.

The deluge began when Rob Szczech scored off a turnover at 5:51 of the third period. A steal and a three-point play by Radigan with 11 seconds left made it 44-39 at the quarter's end.

Radigan tied the score at 46-46 with 4:09 to play with a running shot off the backboard. Szczech gave the Bulldogs the lead with a short jump shot with 3:34 remaining.

Both baskets were part of a run of 17 unanswered points. The Eagles didn't score in the fourth period between a bucket off an offensive rebound by James Steele at 5:12 and a fielder by Wingenfeld with 50 seconds to play.

Falls finished the night shooting 19-of-61 from the field. The Eagles were 20-of-51.

points. Tyson Barnes, with 12 fourth-quarter points, finished with 16.

Elyria actually led 29-20 midway through the second period, but two straight fast-break baskets by Matt Mobley and a crushing 3-pointer brought Parma back into the game, and the upset — mild though it was — was in the making.

Nathan Broz, Jason Sabol and Mobley played the games of their lives with 18, 17 and 15 points, respectively. Ryan Peabody hit all but one of his eight fourth-quarter free throws and Broz was 8 of 10 on the night as the Redmen kept their composure to pull out the win.

HIGH SCHOOL SWIMMING

More big Bartel waves in SWC

Paul Heyse
The Chronicle-Telegram

It's unusual in sports for a freshman to be the star, but in Avon Lake's case last year it might have been apropos.

What better time for a first-year student to shine than in the first year of the sport at the school?

Freshman Brad Bartel led the Shoremen to a Southwestern Conference title.

Avon Lake went on to place sixth in the Northeast District meet at Cleveland State, advancing six swimmers to the state meet at Canton's C.T. Branin Natatorium.

Now a sophomore, Bartel returns to lead the Shoremen's charge for a second straight SWC title. The diving was Friday night at Rocky River High School with today's swimming events start at 11:45 a.m. at Fairview High School.

Bartel finished seventh in the 200-yard individual medley at the state meet. A month later, he took ninth in the USA Junior Nationals at the University of Indiana, winning his consolation semifinal with a career-record time of 1:53.87.

"It was just a great experience going down to state and everything," said Bartel. "I was hoping to place fourth or fifth, but seventh isn't bad. It gives me something to shoot for this year."

He also advanced to Canton in the 100 freestyle, placing 21st. In addition, he teamed with his brother Ray, a junior, along with senior Matt Weber and junior Jon Ulrich, in both the 200 medley and 200 free relays, which placed 16th and 21st, respectively.

"I had a lot of people come up to me at state and congratulate me, people I didn't even know, just because the fact I was a freshman," said Brad, 5-feet-11, 170. "There were probably about three or four freshmen that placed in the top eight at state."

His performance at junior nationals was just as sweet as he dropped another 1.5 seconds.

"That was probably the best surprise of my swimming career," said Bartel. "I had someone next to me the whole way, I was just trying to beat him. I just barely touched him out."

The SWC record-holder in both the 100 and 200-freestyle, Brad's goal is to own all eight conference individual conference swim records by the time he graduates (SWC meet records can only be in the league meet and participants can only swim in two individual events).

"Brad really pays attention to the sport and the competition," said Avon Lake coach Gary Fahey. "He knows the best times of all his top competitors. He just has a mind that really clicks to the sport. I feel lucky to have someone like that."

Right now, Bartel is still looking for a second individual event. Unmistakably, the 200 intermediate medley is his best event.

"I don't have a weak stroke," said Bartel, who owns a 3.6 grade-point average in the classroom. "All four strokes (free, fly, breast and back) are all basically equal for me. It's just worked out good."

Although last season was a memorable one, Bartel isn't resting on his laurels. Far from it.

"I just try to go into practice day in and day out and work as hard as I can and get through it as best as I can," said Bartel. "I just hope it pays off very well at the end of the season."

EC frosh girls win fourth straight

Elyria Catholic's freshman girls defeated Lake Catholic 44-39 for their fourth straight win and upped their record to 10-6.

Tricia Page's seven points led all 12 Panthers into the scoring column. Pattie Leit-

SWC MEET

N.Olmsted diver sets boys' record

FAIRVIEW PARK — North Olmsted's Nate Spice set a meet record, winning the boys diving portion at Friday night's opening of the Southwestern Conference swimming championships.

Spice racked up 476.8 points, shattering the old mark of 452.5 set in 1986 by Rocky River's Ted Rose.

Westlake took first and third in the girls competition with Kathy Carlson winning the event by 7.7 points over Bay Village's Claire Naso.

Swimming events take place today at Fairview High School.

RESULTS
Boys — 1. Nate Spice (NO), 476.8; 2. Noah Soroka (N), 293.8; 3. Matt Dornic (F), 290.85.
Girls — 1. Kathy Carlson (W), 395.1; 2. Claire Naso (B), 387.4; 3. Kristen Demby (W), 354.55.

His passion for swimming is so strong that he gave up both football and baseball to focus his efforts "making waves."

"He doesn't have a bad event," agreed Fahey, an 18-year coaching veteran. "He's the top-ranked swimmer in the conference in seven out of eight events. Some of the times he pulls off in practice are just incredible. When he's really on people can't believe he's that fast. For example, his 200 IM times in practice are faster than some of our best kids' 200 free."

Bartel got a good taste of what's cut out for him on Dec. 20 at the Cleveland State Viking Invitational where he placed third in the 200 IM (1:53.92) and seventh in the 100 butterfly (53.82).

The district leader in the 200 free relay, the Shoremen's relay of Brad and Ray, along with Weber and Ulrich, were fourth (1:29.8) at the Viking meet. The quartet also added a seventh in the 200 medley relay (1:41.5).

"That was basically like the state meet. All the best swimmers were there," said Bartel. "Both of my individual times were my best high school times, although weren't my career bests." Bartel's best times came from junior nationals performances (1:53.87 — 200 IM; 52.99 — 100 fly).

For the present, between now and beginning of the taper prior to the district and state meets (Feb. 21 and 28), Bartel and his teammates are chalking up a lot of heavy yardage, or meterage, at the Aqua Marine in Avon Lake.

The team averages 4,000 meters in the morning workouts (5:30-7 a.m.) and 6,000 meters in the evening practices (3:30-5:30 p.m.).

Akron Firestone, Hawken, Shaker Heights and St. Ignatius are the top contenders for the CSU District meet on Feb. 21, but Avon Lake expects to be the team rounding out the top five.

Bartel's main competition in the 200 IM is defending state champ Tony Kurth, a junior from Toledo St. Francis DeSales.

Three others also return from last year's championship final: Firestone sophomore Mark Gangloff, eighth at state and who beat Bartel at the Viking meet; along with St. Francis senior John Carroll and Hawken senior Dave Krahe. Carroll was fifth at the state last year while Krahe fifth at the Viking meet, one spot behind Bartel.

ner and Clare Wasniak each had six points while Erin Korona added five points.

Page, Wasniak and Katie Poling pulled down nine rebounds apiece for the winners.

Tyson Barnes										
G	F	T			G	F	T			
15	7	3	2	4	3	4	16			
11	7	0	0	2	17					
5	3	0	0	1	6					
5	2	2	1	2	5					
4	2	2	1	1	5					
2	0	0	0	1	0					
1	0	0	0	1	0					
1	0	0	0	1	0					
TOTALS	60	29	11	9	19	58				

PARMA (71)										
G	F	T			G	F	T			
5	5	10	8	2	15					
11	7	0	0	2	17					
9	6	0	0	1	15					
5	5	1	9	7	3					
3	1	2	0	2	4					
3	0	0	4	1	4					
1	0	0	0	1	0					
1	0	0	0	0	0					
0	0	0	0	0	0					
0	0	0	0	0	0					
TOTALS	44	22	25	21	14	71				

Three-point field goals: Elyria — Jeff Cornute, Parma — Jason Sabol 3, Matt Mobley 3.
Rebounds — Elyria 21, Parma 27. Turnovers: Elyria 11, Parma 18.

SCORE BY QUARTERS										
	1	2	3	4	T					
Elyria	20	17	12	19	—	68				
Parma	16	19	20	16	—	71				